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General Comment

I am a citizen of the United States who wants to support American businesses and American excellence on the global stage. And I oppose the current developments in the BIG AI industry, which here in the US is dominated by a technocrats elite from silicon valley (like Google or Sam Altman).

There are major concerns about the use of copyrighted material in the training data used to power these AI models. Sam Altman of OpenAI has admitted any hypothetical AI development can only occur through the use of copyrighted work. So far, major AI companies have broken copyright law, and abused the goodwill of small artists and writers who include their work for free on the internet, as well as the copyrighted work of major companies which occur behind paywalls. These companies did do knowing it was likely illegal, but not caring enough to actually follow it. I am an artist, and I have to be careful when using copyrighted work to ensure I am not violating any laws. It horrified me that large monopolistic companies like Google or Facebook are developing AI models based on copyrighted work, benefiting financially from that work, reducing the value of my work by competing in the same market, while giving me no choice is whether my data can be used to train these models. This has discouraged me from creating new work, for fear my creative works will be stolen without fair compensation.

My first recommendation would be to affirm the ruling AI training data is NOT fair use of such materials. AI companies should pay rights holders for the use of this data. Users should be able to opt out of allowing their data to be used by these companies.

There is also a serious concern with the high energy consumption by AI models. I live in a state where data centers are being proposed, and it concerns me greatly that these companies require such high energy use to run these models. I would advise that protections for ordinary energy consumers be put into place to prevent these companies from siphoning off energy from generators or distribution locations, and making energy availability more insecure for the average American.

In addition, while I am morally opposed to recent AI developments, I worry efforts to ensure American dominance in AI might be a fool-hearty effort to prop up bloated and inefficient companies. The Chinese DeepSeek AI appears to outperform US developments, despite the billions of private capital already funneled into these companies. From my understanding, this is because Chinese developers had to do more with less; they had to work with fewer AI chips and on older software. If we are to compete on the global stage, I believe we should take a page from China's success here.

The Trump administration should encourage these companies to operate a bit more like the many hardworking small businesses across America: do more with less, innovate based on limited materials, and get CREATIVE. American AI cannot dominate globally if it exists as a bloated, old white elephant.